

SAPPHIRE PULSE AMD Radeon RX 9060 XT

Compelling for mainstream gamers

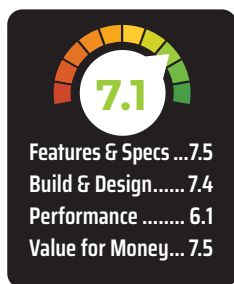
Unveiled at COMPUTEX 2025, the AMD Radeon RX 9060 XT is a mid-range contender from AMD's RDNA 4 graphics card family. With RDNA 4 introducing dedicated AI Cores, the 9060 XT is a solid option for those experimenting with local AI models, thanks to its 16 GB VRAM buffer. With rumours of NVIDIA scaling back consumer GPU production in favor of enterprise cards, AMD has a chance to gain market share—though whether it can is another discussion. For now, let's focus on how the RX 9060 XT performs against its main rival, the NVIDIA RTX 5060 Ti.

The Radeon RX 9060 XT carries a suggested price of USD 349—USD 80 cheaper than the RTX 5060 Ti. That may not sound like much, but in the fiercely competitive mid-range segment, even a USD 20–30 difference can shift market dynamics. In an ideal world where both cards are equal in raster and ray-tracing performance, price alone could sway buyers. But since NVIDIA still leads in ray-tracing, AMD must maintain that cost edge to stay competitive. In markets like India, where middlemen influence pricing, failing to hit the right price point could mean the card gets overlooked by most gamers.

PERFORMANCE

We included the newly launched NVIDIA RTX 50 series cards alongside select RTX 40 series models, including the Super variants. The graphs will be updated once we benchmark the RX 7600 XT, allowing for a gen-on-gen comparison with the RX 9060 XT. The

₹34,900



always, we've included both synthetic and gaming benchmarks, with detailed charts to highlight the differences. Here's the rig we're using.

- Processor – AMD Ryzen 7 9800X3D
- CPU-Cooler – Noctua NH-D15
- RAM – 2x 32 GB Kingston FURY Beast 6000 MT/s
- SSD – Kingston Renegade G5 2TB
- PSU – Cooler Master V850

3DMark

3DMark is a widely used benchmarking tool for evaluating graphics cards and gaming systems. It offers a range of tests that assess different aspects of GPU performance. Key benchmarks include Time Spy, a DirectX 12 test for graphically intense scenes; Steel Nomad, its successor, which empha-

sizes real-time ray tracing and advanced graphics; Speed Way, a DirectX 12 benchmark simulating a high-speed racing game environment; and Fire Strike, a legacy DirectX 11 test that evaluates GPU and CPU performance in typical gaming scenarios.

Ray Tracing

3DMark Port Royale is a synthetic benchmark that uses a real-time ray tracing scene to simulate the reflections, shadows, and other visual effects that are possible with ray tracing technology. Port Royale is a demanding benchmark that can be used to compare the performance of all current graphics cards with real-time hardware-accelerated ray-tracing.

Blender

Blender is a 3D modeling and animation software that's open-source and it is the preferred tool for folks wanting to get their hands dirty with 3D modeling. We used version 4.3. There are three scenes in Blender – monster, junkroom and classroom – with varying design complexities that provide a lot of different textures that can tax the GPU properly.

OpenCL Rendering

This benchmark uses OpenCL to produce photorealistic results through physical rendering, which simulates the real-world behavior of light. Performance is measured by the number of samples calculated—"light particles" that interact with the scene and reach the virtual camera. Because it relies on light physics, this test closely mirrors how GPUs are used in professional and industrial rendering workflows.

API Performance

Basemark GPU is a nice benchmark to compare the different graphics APIs between cards. We can use the same textures with OpenGL, Vulkan and DirectX 12 to see if the GPU excels at an API more than the rest or if the performance is consistent across the board.